



The Personal Project

Student Handbook



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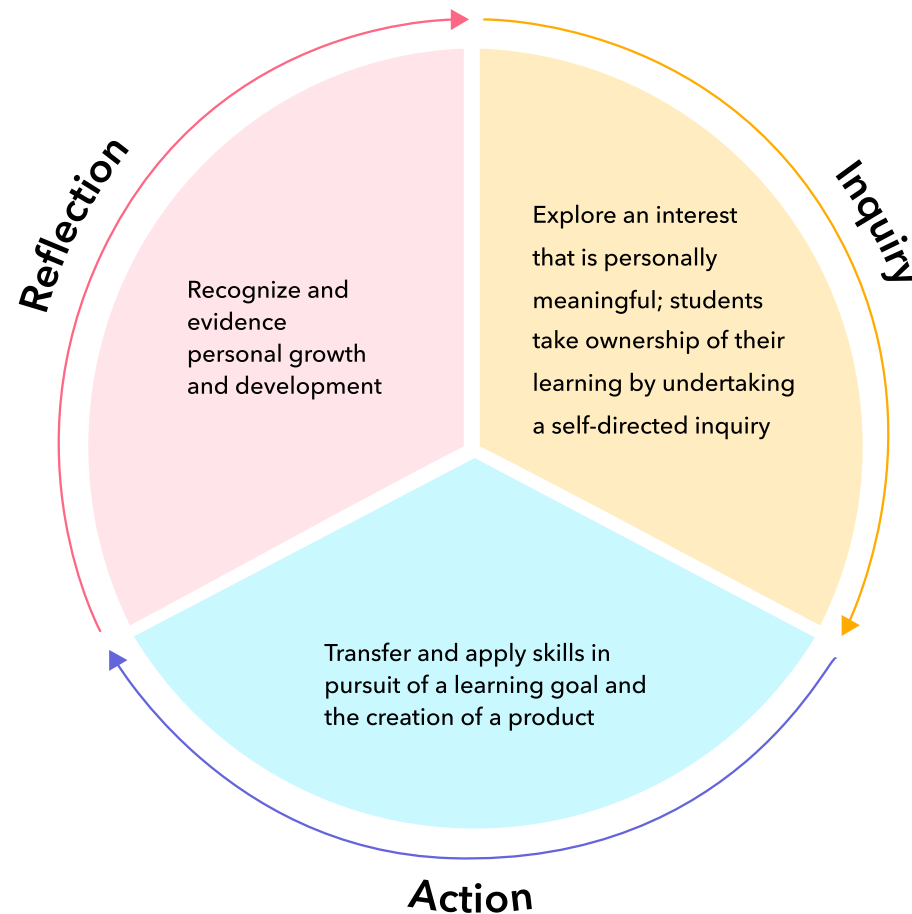


General Guidelines

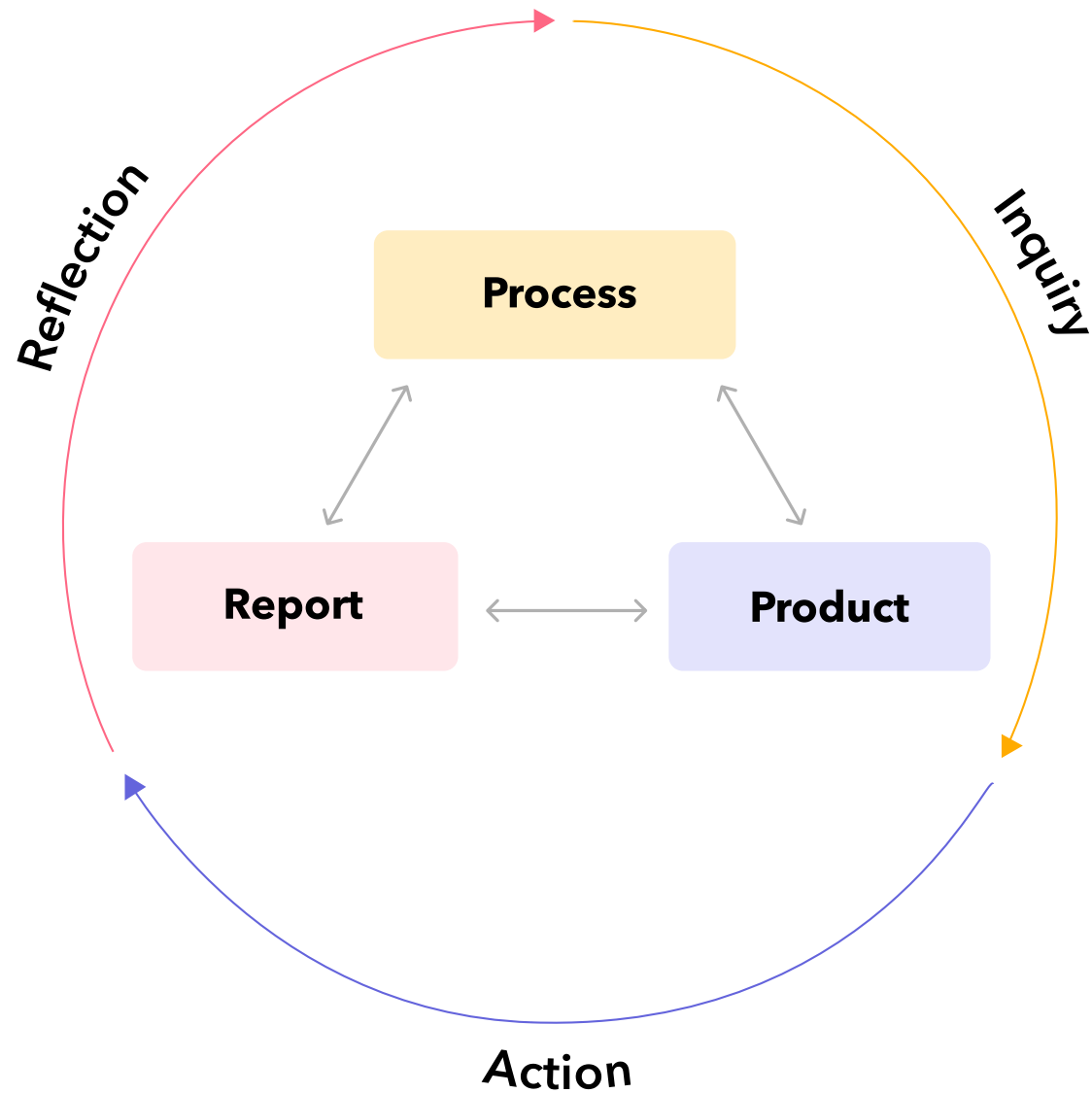
What is the Personal Project?

The personal project is completed by students in the last year of their IBMYP journey. It is a culminating experience that allows students to showcase what they have learnt across the five years of the MYP.

The Aims of the IB MYP Personal Project are:

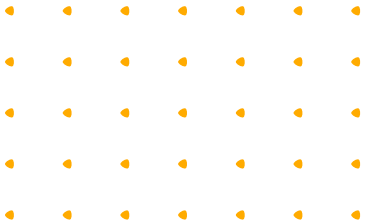


The Personal Project consists of a process of **inquiry**, **action** and **reflection** and results in a **product** and a **report**.



Culminating experience of the MYP

This is YOUR opportunity to follow your passion by choosing an area of personal interest that will keep you engaged throughout the process. It is your personal passion project!



Some ideas for project include:



An original work of art (eg. visual or performance)



An invention or specially designed object



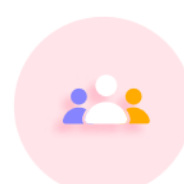
A written piece of work on a specific topic (essay)



The presentation of a plan for a business or community-based organization



A piece of literary fiction (creative writing)

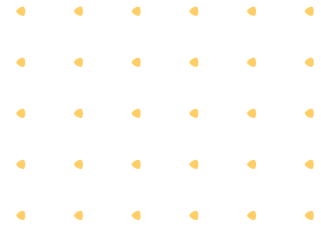


A special event or development of a student or community organization



An original science experiment





What to expect from your supervisor

Your supervisor is responsible for:

- 1 Guiding you through the process
- 2 Ensuring that your topic satisfies appropriate legal and ethical standards with regard to health and safety, confidentiality, human rights, animal welfare and environmental issues
- 3 Giving you guidelines about requirements
- 4 Ensuring you meet the deadlines
- 5 Advising you on how to document the process in your process journal
- 6 Supporting you with personal analysis and reflection
- 7 Providing you with formative feedback on your work
- 8 Ensuring the authenticity of your work
- 9 Assessing your work

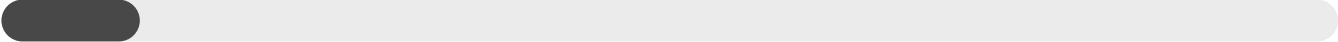
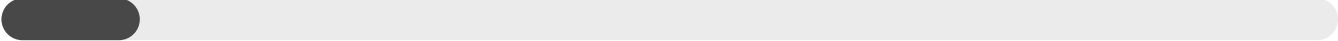
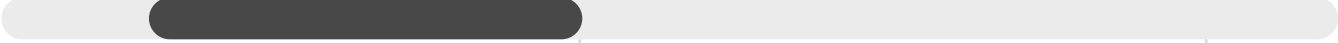
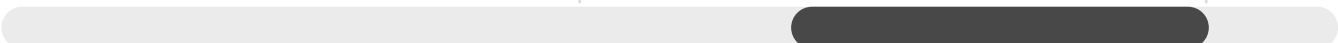
What your supervisor expects from you

- 1 To ask when you need help
- 2 To keep them informed
- 3 To meet deadlines and meeting times
- 4 To manage your time
- 5 To be honest about your work and cite anything you have used from other sources



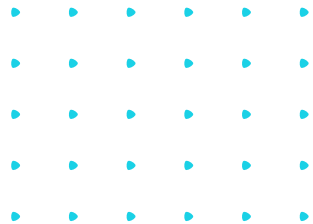
Managing Your Time

Timeline

	Example school calendar for Year 5 students from northern hemisphere school						
	September	October	November	December	January	February	March
Choose your learning goal and product							
Create success criteria and an action plan							
Create your product and achieve your goal							
Keep a record of skills you used							
Reflect on the impact of your product							
Evaluate your product							
Write up your report							

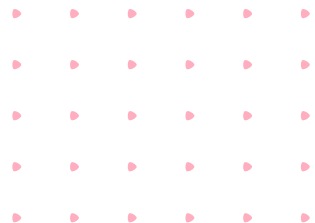
Part 1: Use this timeline to get organized

Task	Due date	Done
Part 1		
Met with my supervisor to discuss my ideas		
Decided on how I will document the process		
Decided on a learning goal and established personal interest		
Brainstormed which products will help me achieve my learning goal		



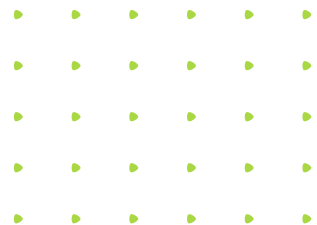
Part 2: Timeline

Task	Due date	Done
Part 2		
Met with my supervisor		
Developed a plan of action		
Developed success criteria		
Started working on my product		



Part 3: Timeline

Task	Due date	Done
Part 3		
Met with my supervisor		
Reflected on the impact of my project		
Evaluated the product		
Created a bibliography		



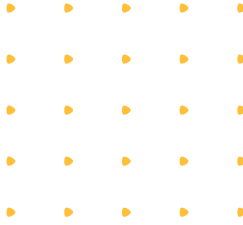
Meeting Minutes Template



Name:		
Date:		
Supervisor:		
Meeting number:		
Aspect(s) discussed:		
Next steps		
Action item	Person responsible	Timeline
Next meeting		
Date:		
Time:		

Working through the personal project

In order to reach the goal, you will address the three objectives for the PP on which they will be assessed– planning, applying skills and reflecting–following the inquiry process.



Planning



Applying skills

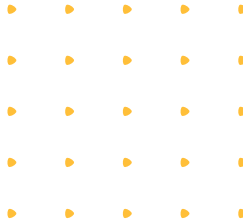


Reflecting



Planning

Setting Learning and Product Goals



What is a learning goal?

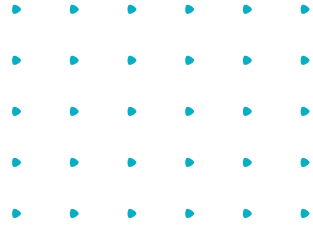
What you want to learn through completing your project



What is a product?

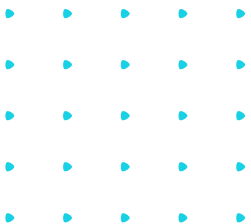
What you will create as you achieve your learning goal

How to Decide on a Learning Goal



Questions to ask yourself:

- 1 To ask when you need help
- 2 To keep them informed
- 3 To meet deadlines and meeting times
- 4 To manage your time
- 4 To be honest about your work and cite anything you have used from other sources



Establishing Personal Interest

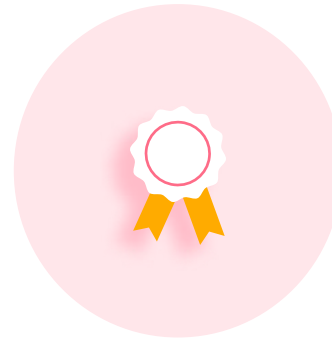
How to channel personal interest:



Do preliminary research



Think about what you love doing



Think about why what you're doing is important



Thinking about what you already know and what you would like to learn



Generating Ideas for Learning goals

01

Interest 1

Why are you interested in this?
What do you want to learn?
What will best help you learn it?
What have you learnt at school that will help you?
What have you learnt outside of school that will help you?

02

Interest 2

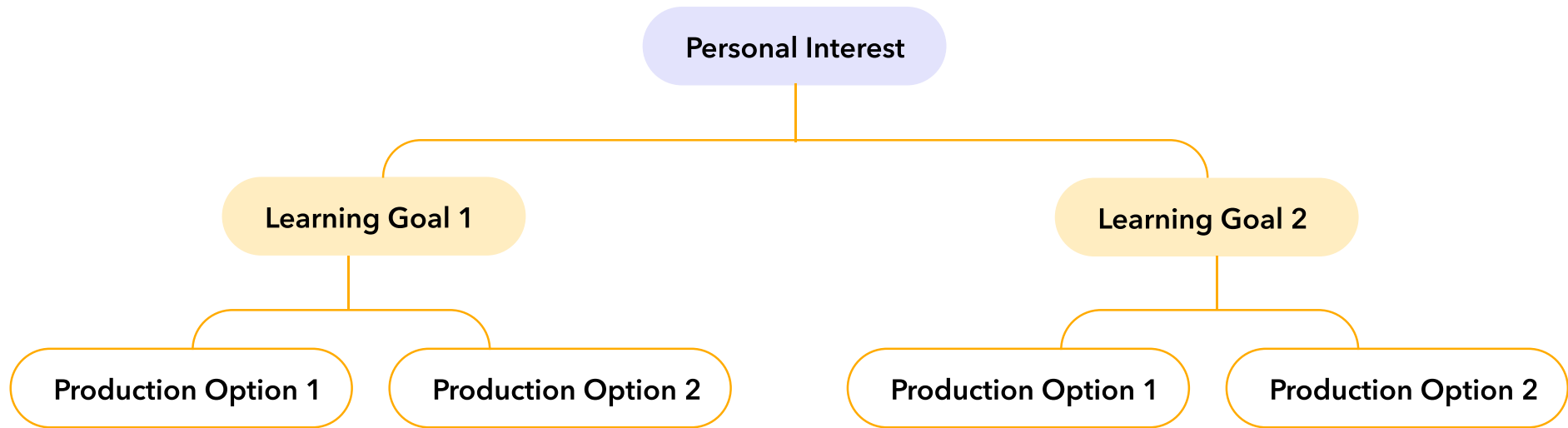
Why are you interested in this?
What do you want to learn?
What will best help you learn it?
What have you learnt at school that will help you?
What have you learnt outside of school that will help you?

03

Interest 3

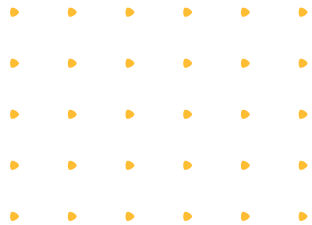
Why are you interested in this?
What do you want to learn?
What will best help you learn it?
What have you learnt at school that will help you?
What have you learnt outside of school that will help you?

Linking Personal Interest to Goals (Aii)

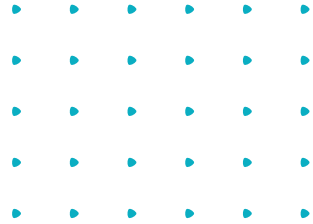


The don'ts of learning goals for students:

-  Don't do something just because someone else has done it before
-  Don't do something just because your friend is also doing it
-  Don't take the easy way out - challenge yourself

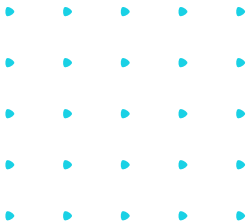


How to Decide on a Learning Goal



Questions to ask yourself:

- 1 What would best showcase my learning?
- 2 Is my product SMART?
- 3 What limitations will I have and how can I overcome them?
- 4 Does my product satisfy appropriate legal and ethical standards with regard to health and safety, confidentiality, human rights, animal welfare and environmental issues?





Creating SMART Goals

Aspect		Description of my goal	Yes	No
S	Specific: Answer the following questions: 1. What do I want to do? 2. Why do I want to do it? 3. Who is involved? 4. Where am I going to achieve my goal? 5. What resources do I need?			
M	Measurable: How will I know if my goal has been achieved?			
A	Achievable: 1. How will I achieve my goal? 2. What limitations may I face? 3. Why is my goal realistic?			
R	Relevant: Why is my goal important? What need is driving my goal?			
T	Time-based: Can I achieve my goal within the timeframe? How?			

Tips to make your product

- 1 Think of your skills. What do you enjoy working on? What have you always wanted to do? What are you passionate about?
- 2 Aim high, but be realistic. What can you achieve in the time-frame? Is your product SMART?
- 3 Is your product the ideal product that will help you achieve your learning goal?

Note:

The product may be a tangible artifact such as a sculpture, film, story or model, or it could be a non-tangible result such as an awareness-raising campaign, learning to play a new piece of music or improving athletic performance

You should be able to achieve the goal (including the learning goal and the product) and prepare the report in 25 hours.

Writing Success Criteria

Your success criteria are important in both the planning and reflecting stages of the project:



Planning stage

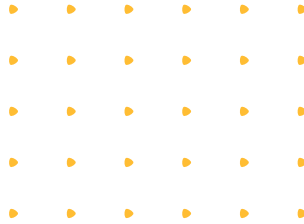
being specific about what you want your final product will be like will help you to clarify your goal develop your action plan



Reflecting stage

you will evaluate your product against the success criteria. The more detailed you are now, the easier it will be to do a thorough evaluation.

The following templates provide some considerations that will help you to develop detailed success criteria.



Option 1: Template for Success Criteria

Specification	Considerations
Function	Describe what your product will do. Be sure to consider: • What environment/conditions it will be used in
User requirements	Who will use my product? What features are important to them?
Form	Describe how the form of the product will support its function. Be sure to consider: • Size • Materials • Cost
Safety	What features will ensure my product is safe?
Aesthetics	What does my product look like?

Option 1: Template for Success Criteria

Specification	Considerations
Function	What will it be used for?
Audience	Who is my target audience? What features of the product will make it useful to them?
Aesthetics, materials and size	What design, colours and materials will make this product effective?
Cost	What is a reasonable cost for my product? What choices can I make to stay within that budget?
Environment	How can I minimize the impact of my product on the environment?
Safety	What are the risks associated with developing and using product? How can I minimize the risks?

Template for Setting Mini-Goals (Aiii)

Big goal 1:			
Mini goals (What do I need to do to complete my big goal?)			
Mini goal 1:		My deadline:	
Mini goal 2:		My deadline:	
Mini goal 3:		My deadline:	
Big goal 2:			
Mini goals (What do I need to do to complete my big goal?)			
Mini goal 1:		My deadline:	
Mini goal 2:		My deadline:	
Mini goal 3:		My deadline:	

Action Plan Template

What do I want to do?	How will I do it?	Who will do it?	What do I need?	When will it be done?	Any changes?

To Do List Template

Item		Related Criteria (circle one)	Done
1.		A,B,C	
2.		A,B,C	
3.		A,B,C	
4.		A,B,C	
5.		A,B,C	
6.		A,B,C	

Calendar Template



Month:

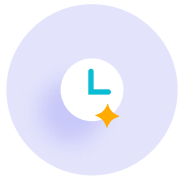
Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

Managing Your Time

Tips for managing your time:



Set mini goals



Don't underestimate your time

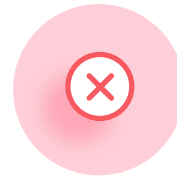


Prioritise

(your supervisor will be able to help you when deciding what needs to be done first)



Write everything down



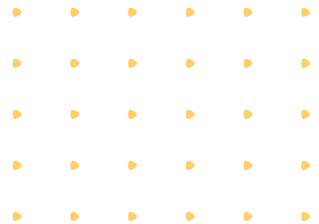
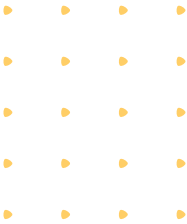
Give time for errors



Give time for breaks



Set time limits for tasks



Tips for Writing Criterion A - Addressing Command Terms

The command terms indicate what is expected of students in order to reach the highest level of achievement. Make sure you pay close attention to the command terms and their definitions as you prepare your report.





Definitions - Criterion A

Learning goal	What students want to learn as a result of doing the personal project.
Product	What students will create for their personal project.
Presents	What students want to learn as a result of doing the personal project.
State	Give a specific name, value or other brief answer without explanation or calculation.
Outline	Give a brief account or summary.
Describe	Give a detailed account or picture of a situation, event, pattern or process.
Explain	Give a detailed account including reasons or causes.



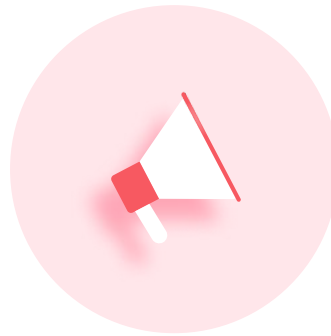
Applying Skills

ATL Skills and Evidence

Throughout the process you will be utilising different skills to help you achieve your learning goal.
Think about the following Skill Categories:



Communication skills



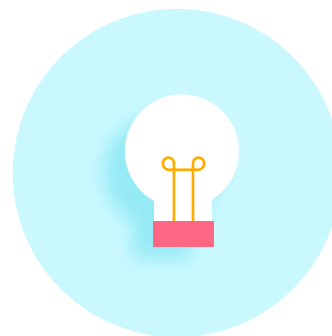
Social Skills



Self-management skills



Research skills

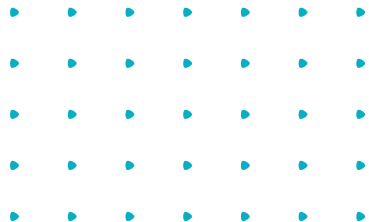


Thinking skills

Keeping Track of ATL Skills

A way to help you keep track of these skills is through documenting your thinking in a process journal. Think about the most important skills you will need to achieve your goal. How will you use them and in what context?

As you record your steps, record the skills you have used and how you have used them. Be specific in your terminology.





ATL Skills and Evidence

Having a colour-coded header like this one can help support you record your skills along the way

	Skill Category: (highlight)				
	Communication	Social	Self-Management	Research	Thinking
Specific skill and how it was used					
	.				



Examples of Evidence for Each Criterion

Once you've recorded the skills you have used throughout the project, you need to provide evidence on how you have used these skills. Ideas for evidence include:

Objective A: Planning	Objective B: Applying skills	Objective C: Reflecting
• a list and/or diagram of interests and related learning goals • a list of possible strategies to achieve personal and academic goals • a diagram showing the connections between the learning goal and the product • a series of steps leading to the completion of the product	• a series of inquiry questions (research skills) • sample correspondence with the project supervisor (communication skills) • screenshot of daily reminders or alerts to complete personal project tasks (self- management) • reflection about resolving a conflict (social skills) • summary of prior learning that is relevant to the project (thinking skills).	• evaluation of the product against the success criteria • images showing key features of the product • analysis of the causes for success and/or failure • summary of new knowledge or insights related to the learning goal

Tips to keep your evidence

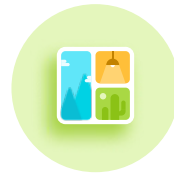


Keep a process journal to document your process. This can be digital or physical. This will help you to produce pieces of evidence that correspond to each strand of the three objectives.

Evidence can be:



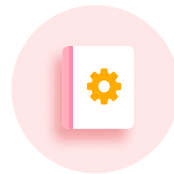
a collection of initial thoughts and developments, brainstorming, possible lines of inquiry and further questions raised



a collection of useful information, for example, quotations, pictures, ideas, photographs



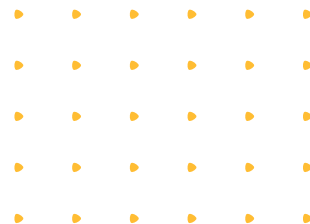
a record of interactions with sources, for example, teachers, supervisors, external contributors



a record of reflections and formative feedback received.



a record of selected, annotated and/or edited research and to maintain a bibliography





Discussing ATL skills

When reflecting on the ATL skills you have used throughout the project it is important to consider your strengths and limitations. Discussing which specific skills you had at the start of the project and which skills you needed to work on is very important. It is also crucial that you discuss which skills you got better at and how. The below table will help you reflect on these skills:

Skill category	Specific skill	My skill level before the project	How I used this skill throughout the project	My skill level after the project
Communication				
Social				
Self-Management				
Research				
Thinking	.			



Tips for Writing Criterion B - Addressing Command Terms

The command terms indicate what is expected of students in order to reach the highest level of achievement. Make sure you pay close attention to the command terms and their definitions as you prepare your report.





Definitions - Criterion B

Learning goal	What students want to learn as a result of doing the personal project.
Product	What students will create for their personal project.
ATL skill(s) clusters	One or more of: communication, collaboration, organization, affective, reflection, information literacy, media literacy, critical thinking, creative thinking, transfer.
State	Give a specific name, value or other brief answer without explanation or calculation.
Outline	Give a brief account or summary.
Describe	Give a detailed account or picture of a situation, event, pattern or process.
Explain	Give a detailed account including reasons or causes.

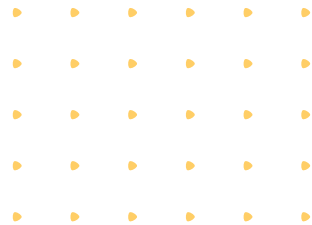


Reflecting

Evaluating your product

- 1 When evaluating your product you need to go back to the success criteria. In Criterion A you indicated what specifications would make your product a success. You need to discuss each specification and reflect on what worked, what didn't and why.
- 2 You also need to consider what you would do differently in the future. If you had a chance to do over your project, what would you change and why.
- 3 Consider the strengths and limitations of your product, being specific about which parts prove these strengths/limitations.

Make sure you evaluate **all** of the success criteria.



Template for Measuring the Success of Your Project

Success Criteria	Was it achieved and how?	What would I have done differently?	Evidence and detailed examples

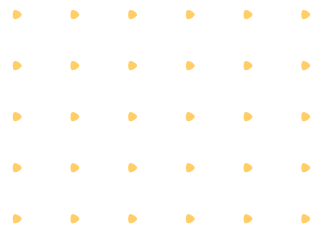


Considering the impact of the project

Now that you have completed your project, you need to consider what impact the project has had on you and your learning.

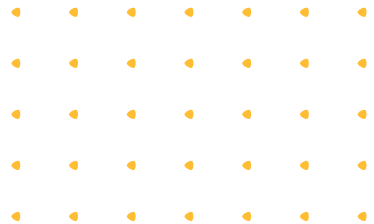
Questions to ask yourself:

- 1 Where were you when you started the project? How is that different from where you are now?
- 2 What new learning have you gained? What are you better at?
What new skills have you learnt or developed further?
- 3 What attributes have you acquired as a result of going through the process?



Explaining the Impact of the Project - Points to Consider

Consider...	Consider...	Consider...	Consider...	Consider...
How have you changed throughout the process? What can you do better now?	What new knowledge do you have? What do you know more about?	What different perspectives have you gained? What didn't you consider when you started?	How have you made the world a better place? What is your contribution?	How will you use what you have learnt in the future? What will be different for you from now on?



Tips for Writing Criterion C - Addressing Command Terms

The command terms indicate what is expected of students in order to reach the highest level of achievement. Make sure you pay close attention to the command terms and their definitions as you prepare your report.

Explain the impact of the project
on themselves or their learning

Give a detailed account
including reasons or causes.

What did you know when
you started the project?

What do you know now?

Evaluate the product based
on the success criteria.

Make an appraisal by weighing
up the strengths and limitations.

What went well? Why?

What didn't go well? Why?



Definitions - Criterion C

Product	What students will create for their personal project.
State	Give a specific name, value or other brief answer without explanation or calculation.
Outline	Give a brief account or summary.
Describe	Give a detailed account or picture of a situation, event, pattern or process.
Explain	Give a detailed account including reasons or causes.
Evaluate	Make an appraisal by weighing up the strengths and limitations.



Preparing the Report

Tips for the report



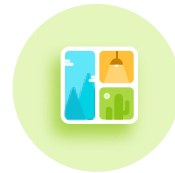
A **report** is a spoken or written account of something observed, heard, done or investigated. A report aims to inform as clearly and succinctly as possible.



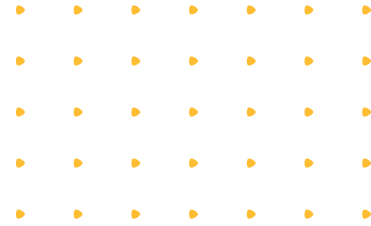
The report should be presented in identifiable sections following the MYP personal project objectives strands—planning, applying skills, and reflecting



The report must include evidence for all the strands of all criteria.



The format of the report for the personal project can vary depending on the resources available and the interests of the students: written, multimedia, podcast or a combination

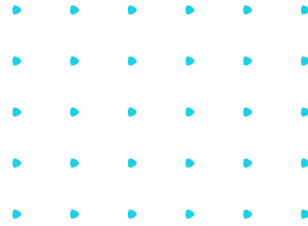




Word Count Requirements

Document File types: .doc, .docx, .pdf (non- editable), .rtf		Recording File types: .mp3, .m4a, .mp4, .mov (codec H264), .m4v
15 pages	and	no recording
14 pages	and	1 minute
13 pages	and	2 minutes
12 pages	and	3 minutes
11 pages	and	4 minutes
10 pages	and	5 minutes
9 pages	and	6 minutes
8 pages	and	7 minutes
7 pages	and	8 minutes
6 pages	and	9 minutes

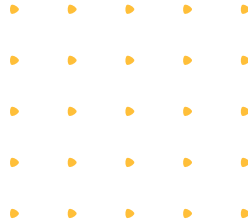
Layout Specifications for Your Report



- 1 Written work needs to have:
 - a | 11-point font size
 - b | 2 cm margins
- 2 Evidence presented in images must be clearly visible.
- 3 Audio and video must be recorded and submitted in real time.
- 4 Visual aids may be used to support spoken reports. However, evidence and examples presented in the visual aids should be submitted as documents. Visual aids presented only in video format will not be considered for assessment.
- 5 The bibliography is uploaded separately and is not included in the page limit.
- 6 Do not include a title page; if included, it will count towards the page limit.

Creating a Bibliography (MLA)

Make sure you document all the sources you used to complete your project.



What I need for printed material:

- 1 The author's name
- 2 The title
- 3 Where and when it was published
- 4 Who published it
- 5 The number of the edition/volume
(if available)
- 6 The page number

What I need for a website:

- 1 The author's name
- 2 The title
- 3 The company or organisation
- 4 The URL
- 5 When you last accessed the page

Examples of Bibliographies



Book

Format: Last Name, First Name. Title of Book. Editions (if any)
Publisher, Publication Year, page(s) cited.

Example: Rowling, J. K. Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets.
1st ed., Scholastic (US), 2021, pp. 10-15



Magazine

Smith, Jane. "The Personal Project". The Myper, 2021, p.
7, Accessed 22 Feb 2021.



Website

Smith, John. "MYP | Toddle". Toddleapp.Com, 2021,
<https://www.toddleapp.com/myp/>. Accessed 5 Feb 2021.



The IB Learner Profile

Inquirers

We nurture our curiosity, developing skills for inquiry and research. We know how to learn independently and with others. We learn with enthusiasm and sustain our love of learning throughout life.

Knowledgeable

We develop and use conceptual understanding, exploring knowledge across a range of disciplines. We engage with issues and ideas that have local and global significance.

Thinkers

We use critical and creative thinking skills to analyse and take responsible action on complex problems. We exercise initiative in making reasoned, ethical decisions.

Communicators

We express ourselves confidently and creatively in more than one language and in many ways. We collaborate effectively, listening carefully to the perspectives of other individuals and groups.

Principled

We act with integrity and honesty, with a strong sense of fairness and justice, and with respect for the dignity and rights of people everywhere. We take responsibility for our actions and their consequences.

Open-minded

We critically appreciate our own cultures and personal histories, as well as the values and traditions of others. We seek and evaluate a range of points of view, and we are willing to grow from the experience.

Caring

We show empathy, compassion and respect. We have a commitment to service, and we act to make a positive difference in the lives of others and in the world around us.

Risk-takers

We approach uncertainty with forethought and determination; we work independently and cooperatively to explore new ideas and innovative strategies. We are resourceful and resilient in the face of challenges and change.

Balanced

We understand the importance of balancing different aspects of our lives—intellectual, physical, and emotional—to achieve well-being for ourselves and others. We recognize our interdependence with other people and with the world in which we live.

Reflective

We thoughtfully consider the world and our own ideas and experience. We work to understand our strengths and weaknesses in order to support our learning and personal development.

